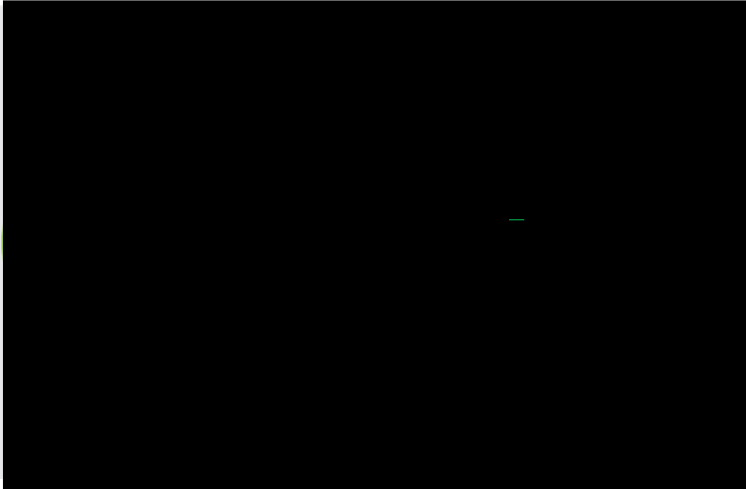


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Business Case for Confluence Adoption



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2026

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1 Executive Summary

This initiative seeks to resolve persistent operational challenges rooted in how knowledge is captured and shared today. Much of our critical information still resides in undocumented tribal knowledge, making it difficult for teams to operate consistently or independently. Unclear ownership often leads to repeated questions and rework, while outdated or hard-to-find files slow progress and create frustration. When responsibilities shift, these gaps become even more visible, making transitions longer and more disruptive than they should be. Collectively, these issues reduce efficiency, hinder onboarding, concentrate knowledge in a small number of individuals, and increase the organization's exposure to operational risk. This is the problem we are trying to solve.

Confluence offers a **centralized, structured knowledge platform** that improves visibility, collaboration, and **governance of business documentation**. As a web-based platform, it can be accessed through a browser, reducing reliance on local file paths and deep folder structures.

This initiative primarily targets process efficiency by reducing time spent searching, recreating, and validating information. Standardized knowledge management also improves business insight by ensuring leaders and teams operate from consistent, reliable documentation. Over time, these efficiency and decision-quality gains mitigate risks and translate into stronger operational performance and long-term shareholder value.

Financially, Confluence requires a modest ongoing license investment, plus a one-time effort to migrate and structure critical documentation. The expected return comes from lower operational friction and reduced key-person dependency specifically, avoiding costly consultant ramp-up when a process owner leaves and teams must reconstruct undocumented knowledge. Over time, fewer work disruptions and faster transitions translate into measurable productivity gains and reduced operational risk.

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2 Defining the Problem

Knowledge fragmentation impacts operations, project delivery, cross-functional collaboration, compliance documentation, and decision-making. Employees often rely on informal knowledge sharing because official documentation is difficult to locate or maintain, leading to inefficiencies and operational risk. The current SharePoint and database-driven approach is an enterprise-wide concern, not just specific use cases.

The organization currently relies on SharePoint and various shared folders to store operational knowledge and documentation. Information such as onboarding resources is buried in deep folder structures, making it difficult to locate, update, and manage.

While the issue is enterprise-wide, its impact is most visible in day-to-day execution where teams need fast access to reliable guidance. In practice, fragmented storage and inconsistent ownership translate into the following recurring challenges.

Key Challenges from Fragmented Documentation

Productivity Loss - As mentioned, operational knowledge is currently fragmented across SharePoint and shared folders, making it difficult for employees to reliably locate process, and policy materials. As a result, time is routinely spent searching, confirming ownership, and validating whether a document is current. When documentation is missing, inconsistent, or outdated, teams often recreate work or re-validate information before proceeding, which increases rework, slows execution, and introduces avoidable delay.

Onboarding Delays - This fragmentation is especially apparent for new joiners, where onboarding becomes slower because the “how-to” steps and required access/setup information are not presented in one clear path. Onboarding delays reflect the same documentation gaps: because guidance is fragmented and not sequenced end-to-end, interns often take more than a week to understand what to do, what to request, where materials are located, and who owns each step. Access setup (accounts, permissions, tickets) is frequently learned through trial-and-error or repeated 1-on-1 support rather than a maintained onboarding path, increasing the supervision burden on managers/peers and delaying time-to-productivity.

Responsibility Transition Risk (Key-Person Dependency) - Over time, the same documentation gaps also make role transitions harder, since critical steps and context are not consistently captured in a way that a successor can quickly pick up and continue the work. When a process owner changes roles or leaves, knowledge transfer often depends on informal handoffs and individual memory rather than consistently documented steps and context. As a result, critical details can be missed, BAU activities may be delayed, and quality issues can arise, especially where processes involve recurring timelines or dependencies that are not captured in an easily accessible form.

Practical Documentation, Improvements Needed - A key driver of the current pain points is that documentation is dispersed across multiple layers of storage, including deep folder structures, SharePoint sites, and standalone files (including Excel sheets, OneNotes, Powerpoints). This makes it difficult to quickly locate the right guidance, confirm it is current, and understand who owns the process. As a result, day-to-day executions rely heavily on ad-hoc coaching and repeated clarification, and transitions become disruptive because critical context is not consistently captured in a retrievable, standardized format.

3 Proposed Solution

Confluence addresses the current-state challenges by establishing a centralized, browser-accessible “source of truth” for documentation, organized into structured spaces and pages, supported by templates and version history, and reinforced through real-time collaboration and integrations with tools like Teams.

3.1 How Confluence Solves the Current-State Gaps

- 1) **Cross-platform access (web + mobile):** Confluence Cloud is accessible through modern web browsers and provides a mobile app experience, enabling consistent access across locations and devices without reliance on local file paths, while supporting on-the-go access to content and updates.
- 2) **Structured knowledge ownership:** Create team/function spaces (e.g., Actuarial, Finance, IT Requests) so documentation is organized by ownership and Intuitive navigation: Use hierarchical page trees (parent/child pages) to make related content easier to find and browse.
- 3) **Standardized documentation:** Use templates to standardize SOPs, onboarding checklists, and project pages so key details are captured in a consistent, easy-to-scan format across teams.
- 4) **Real-time collaboration:** Enable real-time co-editing so teams maintain “living” documentation rather than static files.
- 5) **Contextual clarification:** Use inline and page comments to capture clarifications at the point of use, reducing repeated questions and keeping context attached to the documentation.
- 6) **Teams integration:** Integrate Confluence with Microsoft Teams to create, edit, and share Confluence pages from within Teams.

3.2 Alternatives Considered

To ensure the recommended approach is well-justified, the following alternatives were considered against the same requirements. While each option has strengths, Confluence is preferred overall because it most directly addresses the root causes identified in the current state.

- ❖ **Alternative A — Continue with SharePoint/shared folders (status quo or incremental improvement)**
 - SharePoint is strong for document storage and Microsoft 365 co-authoring/versioning when used as a document library and can work well for file-based collaboration.
 - However, the current-state challenges described in this business case are largely driven by fragmented folders, deep structures, and difficulty maintaining a single “source of truth.” Continuing with a primarily folder/library paradigm of risks preserving the same discoverability and ownership issues (even with incremental improvements).
 - Confluence is purpose-built as a knowledge hub with spaces/pages, page trees, and collaboration features oriented around documentation (not just file storage), which better aligns to the problem being solved.
- ❖ **Alternative B — Notion (all-in-one workspace/wiki)**
 - Notion is a flexible workspace that supports wikis, databases, and templates and is available across web/desktop/mobile.
 - Confluence is preferred where the primary objective is enterprise knowledge management tightly connected to delivery workflows and collaboration in Teams, with mature page history and structured spaces/pages as the default organizing model.
- ❖ **Alternative C — Google Workspace**
 - Google Docs/Drive provides strong real-time editing, comments, and version history for documents.
 - However, using Docs/Drive as a primary knowledge base often remains document-centric rather than providing a dedicated, structured wiki-style workspace with team spaces and page hierarchies as the core organizing model.

- Confluence provides a documentation-first workspace and is natively optimized for cross-team knowledge organization and publishing.

In summary, Confluence is **preferred** overall because it aligns most directly with the problem being solved: it provides a structured, documentation-first knowledge hub built around spaces and pages (with intuitive page trees), supported by templates, real-time editing and commenting, and robust page history that strengthens governance and traceability. In addition, Confluence is accessible cross-platform through supported modern web browsers and is complemented by a mobile app experience, making it easy to adopt across locations and devices. Finally, its ecosystem fit is strong: native integrations with Jira and Microsoft Teams help keep documentation connected to day-to-day work and reduce context switching, which supports sustained adoption over time.

4 Key Business Benefits

The primary value of Confluence adoption is converting fragmented, hard-to-maintain documentation into a governed “source of truth” that people can reliably find, update, and use. This directly addresses today’s pain points.

4.1 Business Continuity & Risk Reduction

By documenting critical procedures and context in a single, owned location, Confluence reduces key-person risk and supports smoother role transitions through standardized transition logs that capture current status, key decisions, risks, and next steps. At the same time, consolidating procedures and decisions in a governed platform with version traceability improves auditability and strengthens operational control.

4.2 Standardization & Governance of Documentation

Standardizing documentation through templates ensures pages are consistently structured and complete across SOPs, onboarding, projects, and transitions. With clear page ownership and periodic reviews, content stays current and duplication is reduced over time. At the same time, space- and page-level permissions allow sensitive information to be appropriately restricted while still enabling collaboration where it makes sense.

4.3 Governance & Ownership

To ensure Confluence becomes a sustainable operating model, lightweight governance is required to keep content accurate, current, and trustworthy over time. Clear ownership, minimum content standards, and permission controls collectively reduce duplication, prevent outdated guidance from persisting, and reinforce a single, reliable source of truth for the organization.

1) Roles & Accountability

- a) Space Owner (Department): accountable for structure, permissions, and quarterly review; ensures critical pages have assigned page owners.
- b) Page Owner (Process Owner): responsible for accuracy of specific SOPs/onboarding/transition logs; maintains “last reviewed” and updates when processes change.
- c) Contributors: propose updates via comments/edits; escalate gaps/risks via page comments and mentions.

2) Content Standards (Minimum Required Fields)

- a) Each critical page must include: Purpose, Owner, Last Reviewed date, Inputs/Outputs, Step-by-step procedure, Links/resources, and Risks/controls (where applicable).
- b) Use standard templates for SOPs, onboarding pages, project pages, and transition logs to enforce consistency.
- c) Permission governance: space/page-level permissions set by Space Owners; sensitive finance/HR content restricted by default.

5 [Examples](#)

Building on the key business benefits outlined above, the following examples illustrate what those improvements look like in practice.

5.1 [Use Case Example: Knowledge & Process Management](#)

In this use case, Confluence serves as a centralized knowledge hub where teams document and maintain processes using structured pages rather than relying on deep database folders. This structure enables clear navigation by function, team, or business unit, making it easier for users to locate the right information quickly. Because pages can be owned and maintained by process owners and subject matter experts, updates are straightforward and remain current over time. Teams can also embed supporting materials directly within the relevant pages, such as documents, links, dashboards, and reference resources, so key context and artifacts are accessible in one place.

5.2 [Practical Example: Team Budget & Expense Management](#)

A current initiative involves maintaining multiple Excel sheets that track budgets and expenses for different teams. The requirement is to enable collaboration while strictly controlling visibility.

To demonstrate how Confluence supports controlled collaboration on financial information, each team's budget and expense table can be maintained in its own dedicated Confluence page (or database entry), creating clear ownership and a consistent location for updates. Team leaders can then review and clarify changes by adding comments directly alongside the data, keeping discussion tied to the numbers instead of spreading it across separate emails or chats. Page-level permissions ensure that each table is visible only to the relevant team and authorized stakeholders (a critical requirement), while still benefiting from a centralized structure that eliminates dependence on deep folders and scattered files. Version history further improves transparency by showing how figures change over time, and leadership can rely on summary dashboards to view high-level metrics without exposing restricted, detailed tables.

Together, these examples illustrate how Confluence moves information from scattered files into a structured, maintainable workspace where teams can document processes, collaborate with the right context, and control visibility without sacrificing accessibility. This helps translate knowledge management from an ad-hoc effort into a repeatable way of working that supports both everyday execution and more resilient transitions over time.

6 Costing

Confluence Plan Options & Pricing Overview

Plan Type	Price per User	What's Included
Free	\$0	Unlimited pages and spaces, database organization, templates (Marketing/Product/Program), up to 3 whiteboards per user, 10 automation runs/month, app integrations, community support, 2 GB storage.
Standard	\$5.16/user/month	Everything in Free plus external collaboration, page permissions, 100 automation runs/month, 250 GB storage, regional 9/5 support, up to 150,000 users.
Premium	\$9.73/user/month	Everything in Standard plus AI-powered knowledge management, dynamic intranet, 1000 automation runs/month per user, unlimited whiteboards, admin insights, unlimited storage, 24/7 critical support, 99.9% uptime SLA.
Enterprise	Upon request	Everything in Premium plus Atlassian Analytics & Data Lake, advanced security and admin controls, enterprise identity management, unlimited automations, multiple sites (up to 150), 24/7 support, 99.95% uptime SLA.

7 Conclusion

Confluence provides a modern, structured solution to replace fragmented document storage systems. Adopting Confluence will improve knowledge accessibility, collaboration, and operational efficiency across the organization.

8 Appendix

The screenshot shows a Confluence page titled "Marketing Plan Template" within a space named "marketing". The page is created by Mario Schaefer and is marked as "UNPUBLISHED CHANGES". A purple banner states: "This template is brought to you by HubSpot, a marketing, sales, and service platform."

The template includes a table for project details:

Driver	
Approver	
Contributors	
Informed	
Campaign name	
Campaign timeline	Feb 24, 2021 - Feb 24, 2021
Creative request due	e.g., Feb 24, 2021
Status	IN REVIEW

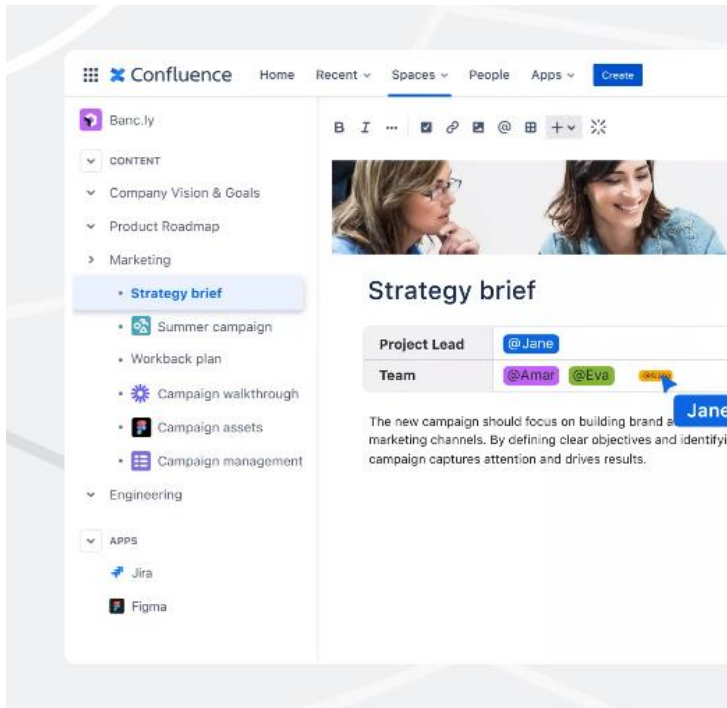
To the right of the table is a list of project components:

- Project overview
- Objectives
- Brand strategy
- Creative requirements
- Deliverables
- Budget
- Timeline & review process
- Competitive analysis

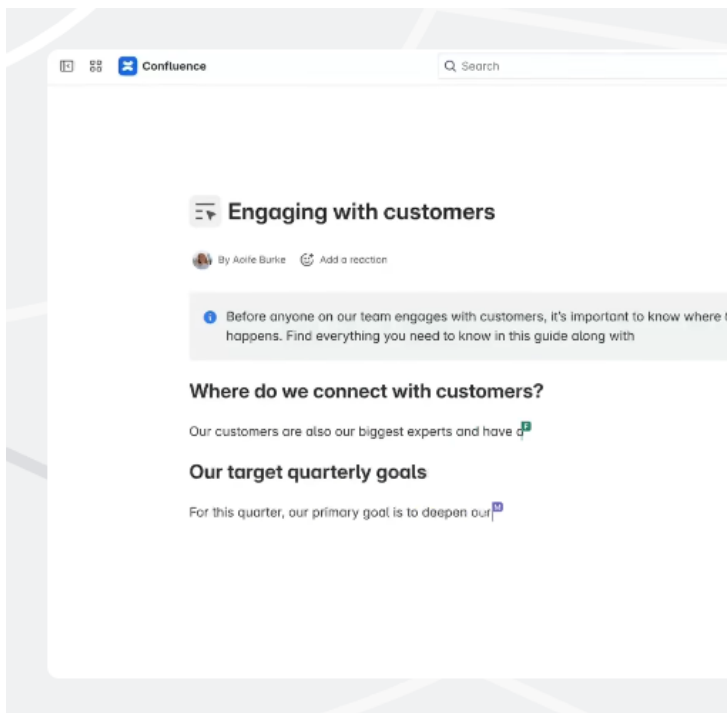
Below the table is a section titled "Project overview" with a table for strategic elements:

Goal	
Opportunities	
Challenges	
Competitive environment	
Selling points	
Value propositions	

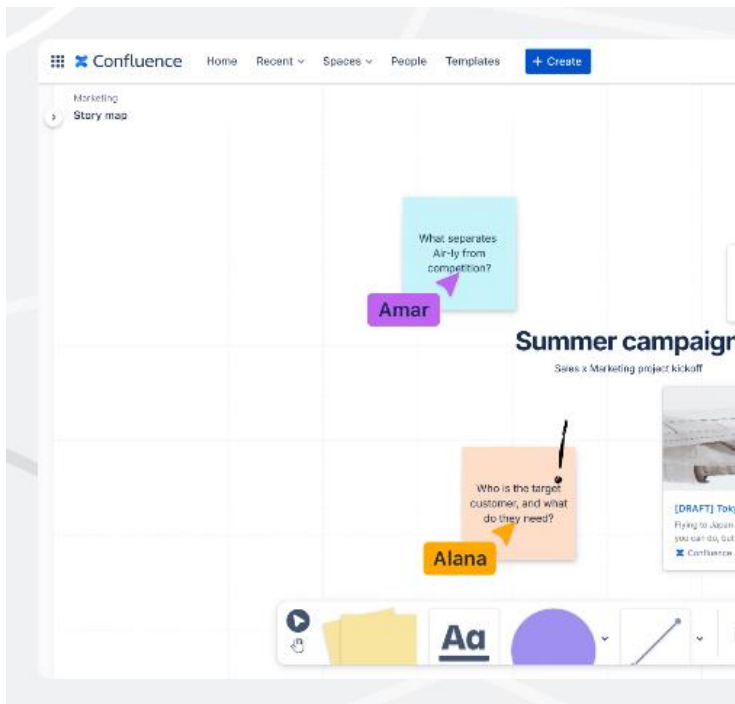
A "Quickstart" button is located at the bottom right of the page.



Confluence Pages – Structured content and navigation replacing deep folder hierarchies.



Confluence Live Docs – Real-time collaborative documentation and knowledge sharing.



Confluence Whiteboards – Visual collaboration for planning, brainstorming, and workflows.

Banc.ly Marketing / ... / Campaign management

Campaign management

Table view

Project	Team	Stage
Digital Advertising	Paid marketing	TO DO
SEO	Content marketing	TO DO
Webinar series	Solutions marketing	TO DO
Field Events	Solutions marketing	TO DO
Sales enablement	Solutions marketing	TO DO
Campaign messaging	Product marketing	IN PROGRESS
Market research	Product marketing	IN PROGRESS
Newsletters	Content marketing	IN REVIEW
Blog content	Content marketing	IN REVIEW
Creative assets	Creative	IN PROGRESS
Email nurture series	Customer lifecycle marketing	DONE
Public relations	Communications	TO DO
Social media campaign	Communications	IN REVIEW

At the top of the table, a blue callout bubble labeled 'Jane' points to the 'Project' column header. At the bottom right, there's a toolbar with icons for zooming, editing, and deleting, along with an 'Edit link' button.

Confluence Databases – Structured tracking of projects, campaigns, and operational data.